Try it at the table

Spider Webs

Gather your things, then try each one. Guess first. Then look closely and write or draw what you saw.

What you need

- [ ] notebook
- [ ] pencil
- [ ] clipboard or stiff cardboard
- [ ] optional magnifying glass
- [ ] optional camera or phone zoom
- [ ] soft morning light (outdoors)

TRY 1 Which lines are sticky on an orb web?

1. From a few steps away, sketch a web you can see.
2. Mark the hub, three spokes, and one loop of the spiral.
3. Do not touch the silk.

I THINK...

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I SAW...

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TRY 2 How can silk catch without glue?

1. On your sketch, label one spiral loop 'maybe glue' and write one question you still have about silk.

I THINK...

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I SAW...

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TRY 3 How does a spider feel a tiny tug?

1. Tap a table lightly with a pencil, then harder.
2. Tell which tap felt bigger through your hand.
3. That is only a toy model of vibration, not a real web.

I THINK…

I SAW…

TRY 4 Why does dew make a web easy to see?

1. On a cool morning, look for a web on a fence or bush.
2. Count how many spiral loops you can see before the dew fades.
3. Stay back and do not touch.

I THINK…

I SAW…